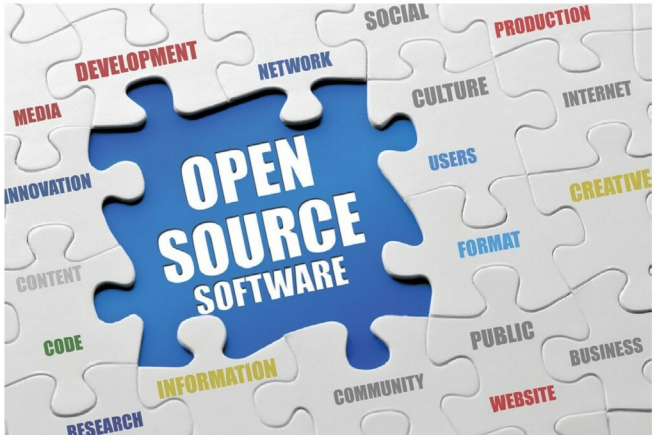


Why Students Should Get Involved in FOSS Development

Developers of proprietary software spend billions on development, yet FOSS is the choice of many of the biggest and best corporate entities. FOSS works on one of the greatest human principles – contribution and sharing. Contributions could be money, time, effort, code, and the list goes on. Students, too, can play a very important role in the development of FOSS.



More than half the world's leading IT organisations are using open source software for its competitive advantage and lower costs. So not only do open source software developers have a body of work to show when they're looking for a job, but they also get the opportunity to nurture their passion for programming and to make a difference.

By getting involved in a FOSS community, you get to work on real-world problems, learn from experts, build a network and, of course, get discovered (that, in many cases, is the biggest hurdle). Your code is out there. If you're up for a job, it shows recruiters that you are concerned about the community and not just about yourself. It shows that you can work, minus any training.

The various open source programmes open to students

Many companies encourage FOSS by managing programmes that enable students to contribute to them.

Google Summer of Code (GSoC) for university students:

Google Summer of Code is a global programme that offers post-higher secondary student developers, of ages 18 and older, stipends to write code for various open source software projects. Google Summer of Code has brought together over 8,500 students with 485 open source projects to create millions of lines of code in the past decade.

- The Google Summer of Code programme is designed to encourage student participation in open source development. Kicked off in 2005, the programme has several goals: